ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 8

SOCIAL SCIENCES

PRACTICE EXAM 2

MARKS: 100 **TIME: 2 hours**

Section A: Geography (50) – scale, coordinates and map projections, a winter-rainfall climate table, rainfall patterns, world climate regions and climate change, settlement patterns and functions, migration, transport and trade. Section B: History (50) – inventions of the Industrial Revolution, deep-level gold mining and its effects, resistance to colonial rule in Namibia, and South Africa in the First World War.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 8. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of TWO sections: SECTION A: Geography (50 marks) and SECTION B: History (50 marks).
2. Answer ALL the questions in BOTH sections.
3. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
4. Read the sources carefully before you answer the questions on them. The sources were written for this examination and are based on historical facts.
5. Show ALL calculations. A non-programmable calculator may be used.

SECTION A: GEOGRAPHY

QUESTION 1: MAPS AND GLOBES

1.1 Choose the correct answer. Write only the letter.

1.1.1 Which type of scale stays correct when a map is enlarged or reduced on a photocopier?

A Word scale B Ratio scale C Line scale D None

1.1.2 All lines of longitude meet at the …

A Equator. B tropics. C poles. D Prime Meridian.

1.1.3 South African Standard Time is based on the meridian of …

A 0° B 15°E C 30°E D 45°E

1.1.4 The International Date Line roughly follows the meridian of …

A 0° B 90°E C 90°W D 180°

1.1.5 A map projection is …

A a way of showing the curved Earth on a flat surface. B a photograph taken from space.
C the key of a map. D a type of compass.

(5)

1.2 A ship is at 33°55′S 18°25′E. (a) In which TWO hemispheres is the ship? (b) Round off its latitude to the nearest whole degree. (3)

1.3 Scale calculations

1.3.1 On a map, the line scale shows that 2 cm represents 1 km. The distance from a school to a river on the map is 7 cm. Calculate the real distance. (2)

1.3.2 Write the ratio scale 1 : 50 000 as a word scale. (1)

1.3.3 On a 1 : 50 000 map, a farm is a rectangle measuring 3 cm by 2 cm. Calculate the real area of the farm in km². (2)

1.4 Give ONE advantage of a satellite image compared with a map. (2)

[15]

QUESTION 2: CLIMATE

2.1 The table shows the average monthly temperature and rainfall of Town Y in South Africa.

Month	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D

Temperature (°C)	21	21	20	17	15	13	12	13	14	16	18	20
Rainfall (mm)	15	15	20	45	80	95	90	80	50	30	20	15

2.1.1 Which is the wettest month? (1)

2.1.2 Calculate the total annual rainfall. (2)

2.1.3 Calculate the annual temperature range. (2)

2.1.4 In which season does most of the rain fall? (1)

2.1.5 Name the climate type of Town Y. (1)

2.2 Explain why the east coast of South Africa receives much more rain than the west coast. (3)

2.3 Give ONE characteristic of each climate region: (a) tropical rainforest; (b) hot desert; (c) polar. (3)

2.4 (a) Give TWO human causes of climate change. (b) Give TWO possible effects of climate change on South Africa. (4)

2.5 Name ONE desert or semi-desert area in southern Africa. (1)

[18]

QUESTION 3: SETTLEMENT, TRANSPORT AND TRADE

3.1 Explain the difference between a nucleated (clustered) and a dispersed (scattered) rural settlement pattern. (2)

3.2 Name a South African town or city that has each main function: (a) a port; (b) mining; (c) administration (government). (3)

3.3 Give TWO push factors and TWO pull factors that cause rural–urban migration. (4)

3.4 (a) Why does South Africa import crude oil? (b) Why is it better for South Africa to export processed goods, such as cars, than raw materials, such as iron ore? (3)

3.5 (a) Which type of transport is best for exporting (i) fresh flowers and (ii) iron ore? Give a reason for each. (b) Give ONE problem with road transport in South Africa. (3)

3.6 Give TWO examples of informal trading in South African cities. (2)

[17]

TOTAL SECTION A: [50]

SECTION B: HISTORY

QUESTION 4: THE INDUSTRIAL REVOLUTION

Study Source A and answer the questions.

SOURCE A: Some important inventions

Year	Invention	Inventor	Importance
1764	Spinning jenny	James Hargreaves	One worker could spin many threads at the same time.
1769	Improved steam engine (patented)	James Watt	Gave efficient power to factories and mines.
1825	First public steam railway (Stockton to Darlington)	George Stephenson	Coal and goods could be moved quickly and cheaply.

4.1 Which invention changed the way thread was made for cloth? (1)

4.2 Who patented an improved steam engine, and in which year? (2)

4.3 Explain how railways helped industries to grow. (2)

4.4 Who were the Luddites, and why did they break machines? (2)

4.5 Describe TWO living conditions of workers in industrial cities. (2)

4.6 What is a trade union, and why did workers form trade unions? (2)

4.7 Give TWO ways in which the Industrial Revolution still affects our lives today. (2)

4.8 Explain how the Industrial Revolution in Europe contributed to the colonisation of Africa. (3)

[16]

QUESTION 5: THE MINERAL REVOLUTION

Read Source B and answer the questions.

SOURCE B: Gold on the Witwatersrand

The gold on the Witwatersrand lay deep underground in hard rock called reef, and each tonne of rock contained only a small amount of gold. Mining companies needed expensive machinery, explosives and very large numbers of cheap workers. By 1899 about 100 000 African men worked on the gold mines, most of them migrant workers on contracts. In 1889 the mine owners formed the Chamber of Mines to recruit workers and to keep wages low.

5.1 Why was gold mining on the Witwatersrand so expensive? (2)

5.2 Why did the mine owners want cheap workers? (2)

5.3 Why was the Chamber of Mines formed? (2)

5.4 What were pass laws, and why were they used on the mines? (2)

5.5 Explain how the discovery of gold led to conflict between the British and the Boer republics. (3)

5.6 Name TWO places from which migrant workers came to the mines. (2)

5.7 Give TWO ways in which the Mineral Revolution changed South Africa's economy. (2)

5.8 Who were the "Randlords"? (1)

5.9 In which city is the "Big Hole" diamond mine found? (1)

[17]

QUESTION 6: COLONIALISM AND THE FIRST WORLD WAR

6.1 Read Source C and answer the questions.

SOURCE C: Resistance in German South West Africa

Between 1904 and 1908, German colonial troops in German South West Africa crushed an uprising by the Herero and Nama people, who had lost much of their land and cattle to German settlers. Tens of thousands of Herero and Nama people were killed or died of hunger and thirst after being driven into the desert or held in camps. In 2021 the German government officially recognised these events as genocide.

6.1.1 What is German South West Africa called today? (1)

6.1.2 Which TWO groups rose up against German rule? (1)

6.1.3 Why did they rise up against the Germans? (2)

6.1.4 Explain what *genocide* means. (2)

6.1.5 Why was it important that Germany officially recognised the genocide in 2021? (1)

6.2 South Africa and the First World War

6.2.1 On which side did South Africa fight in the First World War? (1)

6.2.2 Which German colony did South African forces invade in 1915? (1)

6.2.3 In which country did South African soldiers fight the Battle of Delville Wood in 1916? (1)

6.2.4 Describe TWO conditions that soldiers faced in the trenches. (2)

6.2.5 Name TWO new weapons used in the First World War. (2)

6.2.6 In which year was the Treaty of Versailles signed, and what was ONE of its terms for Germany? (2)

6.2.7 On which date did the fighting of the First World War end? (1)

[17]

TOTAL SECTION B: [50]

TOTAL: 100

END OF QUESTION PAPER